

English Ladder

Student Workbook

Understanding the Usage of "Recommend" and "Suggest"

A polished self-study handout designed for print or tablet use. Read the concept, notice the pattern, and then complete the matching practice set on your own.



Grammar Concepts #17

Key Points

Additional Examples

Practice Exercises

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Understanding the Usage of "Recommend" and "Suggest"** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER



Concept #17 ► Recommend & Suggest

The words **"recommend"** and **"suggest"** use a unique verb style. We will first look at the normal style, then at the unique style of these special verbs.

Normal

Most verbs are followed by an object pronoun such as **"me"**, **"her"**, and **"them"**. The style is of the form **"He [verb] [object pronoun] to [action]."**

My boss wants **me to** finish the report soon.
I need **you to** set up a meeting for Friday.
She expected **us to** return to the office by noon.



Unique

However, a small set of verbs use subject pronouns such as **"I"**, **"she"**, and **"they"**. This set includes: **Suggest | Recommend | Hope | Insist | Prefer | Request**. This style is of the form **"He [verb] (that) [subject pronoun] [action]."**

I suggested (that) **they** take a break.
I hope (that) **she** does not burn out from overwork.
He insisted (that) **I** go home since I looked tired.
I prefer (that) **she** give me fewer assignments.
He requested/insisted (that) **we** work remotely.



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Core Idea

In English, the verbs "recommend" and "suggest" follow a unique pattern compared to most other verbs. Let's break down these patterns to help you understand their proper usage.

Quick reference

Normal Verb Pattern	My boss wants me to finish the report soon. "wants" is the verb, "me" is the object pronoun, and "to finish" is the action.
Unique Verb Pattern	I suggested (that) they take a break. "suggested" is the verb, "they" is the subject pronoun, and "take a break" is the action.

Key Points

Normal Verb Pattern

Most verbs in English are followed by an object pronoun (e.g., me, her, them) and then an infinitive form of the verb (to + action). This structure looks like:

He [verb] [object pronoun] to [action].

Here are some examples to illustrate this pattern:

- My boss wants me to finish the report soon. "wants" is the verb, "me" is the object pronoun, and "to finish" is the action.
- I need you to set up a meeting for Friday. "need" is the verb, "you" is the object pronoun, and "to set up" is the action.
- She expected us to return to the office by noon. "expected" is the verb, "us" is the object pronoun, and "to return" is the action.

In these sentences, the verbs (wants, need, expected) are followed by an object pronoun (me, you, us) and then the infinitive form of another verb (to finish, to set up, to return).

Unique Verb Pattern

A small set of verbs, including "suggest," "recommend," "hope," "insist," "prefer," and "request," use a different structure. Instead of an object pronoun, these verbs are followed by a subject pronoun (e.g., I, she, they) and sometimes the word "that" before the action verb.

The structure looks like this:

He [verb] (that) [subject pronoun] [action].

Let's look at some examples:

- I suggested (that) they take a break. "suggested" is the verb, "they" is the subject pronoun, and "take a break" is the action.



- I hope (that) she does not burn out from overwork. "hope" is the verb, "she" is the subject pronoun, and "does not burn out" is the action.
- He insisted (that) I go home since I looked tired. "insisted" is the verb, "I" is the subject pronoun, and "go home" is the action.
- I prefer (that) she give me fewer assignments. "prefer" is the verb, "she" is the subject pronoun, and "give" is the action.
- He requested/insisted (that) we work remotely. "requested/insisted" is the verb, "we" is the subject pronoun, and "work remotely" is the action.

In these sentences, the verbs (suggested, hope, insisted, prefer, requested/insisted) are followed by a subject pronoun (they, she, I, we) and the action verb (take a break, does not burn out, go home, give, work).

Additional Examples

To further illustrate these unique patterns, here are more examples:

- Suggest She suggested (that) he try the new restaurant. They suggested (that) I start the project early.
- Recommend I recommend (that) you visit the museum. We recommend (that) he take the advanced course.
- Hope I hope (that) they arrive on time. She hopes (that) you succeed in your career.
- Insist They insisted (that) she attend the meeting. He insists (that) I follow the guidelines.
- Prefer I prefer (that) he speaks softly. We prefer (that) she stay at home today.
- Request I requested (that) they send the documents by email. She requested (that) I join the discussion.

Practice Exercises

- Fill in the blanks with the correct form: She _____ (suggest) (that) I _____ (read) the book. We _____ (hope) (that) he _____ (arrive) soon. He _____ (recommend) (that) she _____ (study) for the test. They _____ (insist) (that) we _____ (participate) in the event. I _____ (prefer) (that) you _____ (work) on the project.
- Rewrite the sentences using the unique verb pattern: My teacher wants me to complete the assignment. The manager needs them to attend the meeting. She asked us to help with the preparation.

Understanding these unique patterns will help you use these special verbs correctly in your sentences. Practice using them to become more comfortable with these structures.



Practice Check

Answer the quiz questions below with responses consistent with the grammar concepts taught on the left.

ITEM 01

My boss suggested _____ take a day off.

- A. I
- B. me
- C. my

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 02

The teacher insisted _____ be quiet during the lesson.

- A. we
- B. us
- C. our

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 03

It is crucial he _____ the project on time.

- A. finish
- B. finishes
- C. finished

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 04**

They recommended she _____ the report twice.

- A. check
- B. checks
- C. checked

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 05

The coach insisted they _____ more focused during practice.

- A. be
- B. are
- C. were

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 06

It is important _____ be on time for the meeting.

- A. I
- B. me
- C. my

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 07**

The manager asked that he _____ the report by Monday.

- A. submit
- B. submits
- C. submitted

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 08

She requested that we _____ the meeting.

- A. attend
- B. attends
- C. attended

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 09

It is necessary they _____ informed of any changes.

- A. be
- B. are
- C. were

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 10**

The director suggested she _____ the proposal carefully.

- A. review
- B. reviews
- C. reviewed

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 11

The lawyer recommended we _____ cautious with their statements.

- A. be
- B. are
- C. were

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 12

It is vital he _____ the rules clearly.

- A. understand
- B. understands
- C. understood

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 13**

The instructor demanded she _____ the assignment on time.

- A. complete
- B. completes
- C. completed

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 14

It is essential we _____ early tomorrow.

- A. arrive
- B. arrives
- C. arrived

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 15

The judge ordered they _____ in court.

- A. appear
- B. appears
- C. appeared

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 16**

The doctor suggested I _____ a break.

- A. take
- B. takes
- C. took

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 17

It is recommended he _____ the instructions.

- A. follow
- B. follows
- C. followed

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 18

The principal insisted we _____ on time.

- A. be
- B. are
- C. were

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 19**

The committee suggested they _____ the policy.

- A. review
- B. reviews
- C. reviewed

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 20

It is imperative she _____ prepared.

- A. be
- B. is
- C. was

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 21

The supervisor recommended we _____ the training.

- A. attend
- B. attends
- C. attended

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 22**

It is crucial they _____ confidentiality.

- A. maintain
- B. maintains
- C. maintained

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 23

The board suggested he _____ the budget.

- A. approve
- B. approves
- C. approved

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 24

It is advised we _____ calm during emergencies.

- A. stay
- B. stays
- C. stayed

Correct choice: _____



Self-check Answer Key

Use the key after you have completed every item on your own.

Item 01 A. "My boss suggested I take a day off." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses "I" as the subject pronoun.

Item 02 A. "The teacher insisted we be quiet during the lesson." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses "we" as the subject pronoun.

Item 03 A. "It is crucial he finish the project on time." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "finish."

Item 04 A. "They recommended she check the report twice." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "check."

Item 05 A. "The coach insisted they be more focused during practice." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "be."

Item 06 A. "It is important I be on time for the meeting." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses "I" as the subject pronoun.

Item 07 A. "The manager asked that he submit the report by Monday." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "submit."

Item 08 A. "She requested that we attend the meeting." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "attend."

Item 09 A. "It is necessary they be informed of any changes." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "be."

Item 10 A. "The director suggested she review the proposal carefully." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "review."

Item 11 A. "The lawyer recommended we be cautious with their statements." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "be."

Item 12 A. "It is vital he understand the rules clearly." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "understand."

Item 13 A. "The instructor demanded she complete the assignment on time." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "complete."

Item 14 A. "It is essential we arrive early tomorrow." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "arrive."



Item 15 A. "The judge ordered they appear in court." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "appear."

Item 16 A. "The doctor suggested I take a break." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "take."

Item 17 A. "It is recommended he follow the instructions." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "follow."

Item 18 A. "The principal insisted we be on time." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "be."

Item 19 A. "The committee suggested they review the policy." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "review."

Item 20 A. "It is imperative she be prepared." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "be."

Item 21 A. "The supervisor recommended we attend the training." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "attend."

Item 22 A. "It is crucial they maintain confidentiality." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "maintain."

Item 23 A. "The board suggested he approve the budget." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "approve."

Item 24 A. "It is advised we stay calm during emergencies." is correct. The subjunctive mode uses the base form of the verb "stay."
